

Project Progress Report (Part A)

Start Assignment

- Due Monday by 17:00
- Points 36
- Submitting a file upload
- File types pdf
- Available until 25 Nov at 17:00

In this work, you will record your progress to date. We recommend employing [this LaTeX template](https://protect-au.mimecast.com/s/xkC7CE8wo2lIXqyyhw30HS?domain=overleaf.com)  (<https://protect-au.mimecast.com/s/xkC7CE8wo2lIXqyyhw30HS?domain=overleaf.com>), or following the advice of your supervisor, but in any case your report should be a pdf.

Discuss your particular project and goals with your supervisor to decide how to structure your report. When we mark your report, we will aim to provide feedback that guides you to improve your report writing and analysis.

Specific recommendations

1. Take the time to explain your work. For each figure/code/result: why was this important enough to include? Describe what the figure/etc shows. Explain what the results mean. Remember that we can only mark the understanding that you demonstrate in the report.
2. Include figures! Use captions in the figure to point out which part of the report the figure is relevant to, and make sure to reference those figures in the corresponding section of the report.

The project report has a **word limit of 6000 words**. We encourage you to keep the introduction sections brief; we have already read those. Most of the report should be about your work.

Final Report MDS

Criteria	Ratings				Pts
Overall	3 Pts Excellent A good report template is used and enhanced when appropriate, for instance, by creating new sections.	2 Pts Good Template is used, though it is followed too closely for the given material, for example an opportunity was missed to customise it in some way to good effect.	1 Pts Adequate Some careless variations from the template, or failure to update obvious components such as skeleton section headings.	0 Pts Inadequate The template is not used, or broken in some way.	3 pts
English	3 Pts Excellent Grammar and spelling are all correct, and stylistically appealing. A formal style is preferred, with some allowed variation for readability.	2 Pts Good Grammar and spelling are all correct (barring 1 or 2 minor typos). Style is at least consistent.	1 Pts Adequate There are more than 1 or 2 typos, but broadly correct use of English. Style is reasonable, but sometimes inconsistent.	0 Pts Inadequate Frequent significant grammatical mistakes (e.g., inconsistent use of tense, incorrect or ambiguous pronouns, missing or incorrect definite and indefinite articles, ...). Repeated spelling mistakes. Other poor use of language, including overly informal language, or overuse of, for instance, passive constructions, or uninformative abstract nouns (e.g., thing).	3 pts
Figures and Tables	3 Pts Excellent Tables and figures add to the	2 Pts Good Tables and figures are: (1)	1 Pts Adequate Most tables and figures are	0 Pts Inadequate Uncaptioned tables or figures.	3 pts

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	enjoyment of reading the report.	appropriate to the story being told, (2) well captioned, (3) clearly readable, and (4) explained in the text (as well as captions).	appropriate, but there are some deviations from the above, for instance, some figures that add little to underlying message of the report.	Unlabelled axes. Illegible labels or other data. Poor import of figures (e.g., resulting in pixelisation).	
Structure	3 Pts Excellent Sections and other structures relate well to the material covered, and help make the report more readable.	2 Pts Good Document structures are appropriate, but not edifying.	1 Pts Adequate Sections, paragraphs or other document structures mostly appropriate, but are sometimes awkward, or material contained in them is not logically part of that section.	0 Pts Inadequate Sections or other structures are badly chosen. Required sections, e.g., abstract, introduction or conclusion are missing.	3 pts
Mathematics/code	3 Pts Excellent Included mathematics is appealing, well-integrated with the text, and follows all required conventions (e.g., punctuation of equations, colouring of variables, ...). Code is included (in an appendix if not directly relevant to the discussion in the report) and neatly presented. Notation is well-	2 Pts Good Mathematical typesetting is appropriate. Mathematical conventions are respected. Notation is well-defined, and consistent.	1 Pts Adequate All correct, but poorly typeset in places, or some typos, e.g., occasional missing punctuation. Poor integration of mathematics/code with text, e.g., banks of unexplained equations or functions, not described in the text.	0 Pts Inadequate Frequently undefined notation, or inconsistent notations (for instance the same symbol used to mean two different things).	3 pts

Criteria	Ratings				Pts
	defined, and consistent.				
Evidence of understanding	3 Pts Excellent Assumptions and limitations are clearly stated. Clear explanations of advantages and disadvantages of techniques. Compelling descriptions of real instantiations of techniques, e.g., via simulation results.	2 Pts Good Assumptions and limitations are clearly stated. Examples are used to illustrate key ideas.	1 Pts Adequate Some (trivial) inaccuracies or mistakes in derivations. Ideas are explained but only by paraphrasing existing texts, or the explanations are not clear, or with only few examples.	0 Pts Inadequate Frequent missing assumptions or discussion of limitations. Frequent inaccuracies, or incorrect derivations. Incorrect statistical techniques applied to data.	3 pts
Focus	3 Pts Excellent Work is well motivated. Extraneous points are well sign-posted, so that they do not distract from the main point of the report. Information is presented at the correct level for the audience.	2 Pts Good The message of the report is clear and concise. Information is at the correct level for the audience.	1 Pts Adequate Some digressions or extraneous material, or material that makes incorrect assumptions about the audience level of knowledge.	0 Pts Inadequate The work contains a mass of incoherent material, making it hard to understand the underlying message of the report. Missing details make the material unreadable to the intended audience.	3 pts
Organisation	3 Pts Excellent Information presented in logical and interesting sequence. Goals and results of work are clear.	2 Pts Good Information presented in a logical sequence, e.g., terms defined before or during use, and ideas introduced in a sequence	1 Pts Adequate Information not always presented in a logical sequence, or transitions between topics are weak, but overall sequence	0 Pts Inadequate Information not presented in a logical sequence.	3 pts

Criteria	Ratings				Pts
		that builds understanding of the topic.	is still possible to understand.		
References	3 Pts Excellent References support ideas well. All sources are correctly attributed. Bibliography is well formatted.	2 Pts Good All sources are correctly attributed. Bibliography is well formatted.	1 Pts Adequate References are mostly used correctly, but with some formatting or other problems.	0 Pts Inadequate Incorrect references. Poorly formatted bibliography. References are not cited in the text.	3 pts
Data/experiments	3 Pts Excellent Any data used is described in detail. Any experiments are described at a level of detail sufficient for reproducibility.	2 Pts Good Data and experiments are described in sufficient detail, but the description is overly tedious or awkward.	1 Pts Adequate Data and experiments are mostly described, but the reader is left with some questions.	0 Pts Inadequate Data not described. Simulations or other experiments not described.	3 pts
Working and planning independently	6 Pts Excellent Strong evidence of working and planning independently. Substantial initiative shown in tackling the research question, and pursuing the direction of the individual project independently, to produce a high quality report.	4 Pts Good Considerable interest shown in the project, as well as a willingness to pursue an independent direction with minimal guidance from the project supervisor.	2 Pts Adequate Some initiative shown, but largely doing the bare minimum required in the project, and relying mostly (or entirely) on the direction of the project supervisor.	0 Pts Inadequate Little to no interest in the project. No evidence shown of striving toward independently planning and working on the research question.	6 pts
Total points: 36					